

FREE DOWNLOAD MANAGER



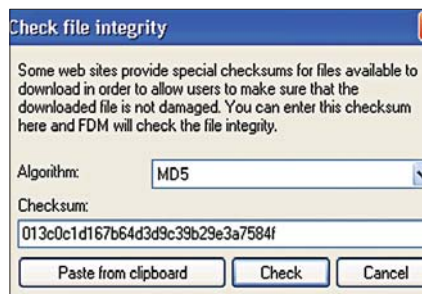
Free Download Manager (FDM) has been gaining popularity for being a minimal and clean download manager that has some really useful features built into it. We look at some of FDM's unique features.

Limit The Speed For A Single Download

Speed limiting is a feature available in almost all download managers, but what makes FDM unique is its ability to limit speeds for one particular download. When you add a new download by selecting Downloads > Create new download, click on the Advanced button in the window. Click the Limit traffic checkbox and set the maximum bandwidth you want the download to use.

Check File Integrity

People normally use download managers to download files that usually would take much longer than five to 10 minutes. Some huge downloads like Linux distribution ISOs come along with a MD5 checksum



Downloaded files can be verified using checksum values

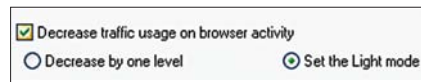
value—an alphanumeric value that can be used to verify whether the download was completed without corruption. Use the drop-down and choose the algorithm used to check the file. Under Checksum, copy and paste the value provided by the download site or developer. Click Check and you will get a confirmation on whether the download has any problems.

Remove The Advertisements

FDM has a small advertisement bar at the right top of the window, and that might turn some people off. You should know that it can be disabled by simply right-clicking on it and clicking Hide.

Better Browsing Speeds While Downloading

FDM gives you the option to use one of three bandwidth priority levels—Light, Medium, and Heavy. You can switch to any of them by pressing [Ctrl] + [1] / [2] / [3] respectively. FDM even has an option that allows it to detect any browsing activity and reduce its download rates immediately. To enable this option, go to Options > Download options > Network tab. Check the box called Decrease traffic usage on

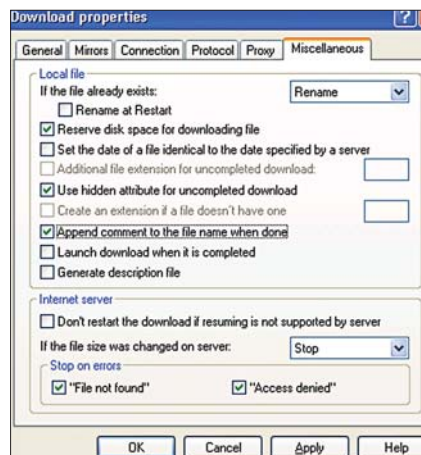


Download speeds can be reduced to allow better browsing speeds

browser activity. You can use the radio button to choose whether you want the bandwidth usage level to drop by one, or set it to Light mode.

Adding Comments To Filenames

Some of us need to add comments for downloaded files to avoid confusion due to odd naming conventions. FDM can rename your downloaded file with the



Comments for a download can be added to the downloaded file's name

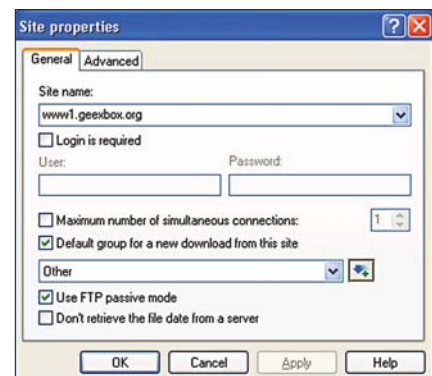
comment appended to it. To be able to set this option, you first enter a comment to a download that's about to begin. Select Downloads > Create new download. Enter, in the Comment text field, the text you want as the comment. Then select Advanced > Miscellaneous and click the box called Append comment to the file name when done. Click Apply and then OK.

Scheduling Selected Downloads

There may be scenarios when you want certain downloads to begin at a particular time and the rest to start a bit later. First create a schedule by clicking the Scheduler tab in the FDM window. Click the Scheduler menu and click Add task. Use the drop-down and click Start download. From the list of downloads that have been added, select the downloads you want to schedule. Click the "Up Arrow" button to add them to the schedule. Click on the Start time tab and select the schedule details. Click OK.

The Site Manager

Many a time, a site will have a limitation on how many connections can be made simultaneously to it. Any more and you can end up banned or have the downloads stopped or delayed. The site manager is a list where you can add rules for your favourite sites. It allows you to add settings to be used



The Site Manager is useful in setting permissions and settings for sites

while downloading, such as the maximum number of connections and authentication information. The site manager can be started by clicking the Site Manager tab in FDM. Here, right-click in the main window and click Add site. Enter the site address and input all the necessary settings. Click OK.

Quick Queuing Downloads

Pretty much every time you wish to download a file, you have to confirm it. The silent mode feature in FDM allows you start downloads in the background without popping up any